KIFAYAH

FOOD SAFETY & HYGIENE STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Quality Assurance & Hygiene Compliance | Operational SOP

Document ID	KFY-QA-SOP-001	**Version**	1.0 (Draft for approval)
Effective date	To be assigned at approval	**Review cycle**	At least annually and after a significant incident or process change
Process owner	Head of Quality Assurance & Hygiene Compliance	**Applies to**	Procurement, receiving, warehouse, cold storage, picking, packing, dispatch and cleaning teams

Document status: Controlled draft. The designated Kifayah approver must authorize this SOP, assign an effective date, train affected staff and confirm that site-specific legal and technical requirements are met before operational use.

1. Purpose

Establish consistent controls to protect food safety, halal integrity, product quality and customer confidence throughout supplier approval, receiving, storage, handling and dispatch. This SOP sets minimum internal controls; stricter product-label, certification-scheme, competent-authority or customer requirements take precedence.

2. Scope and responsibilities

Head of QA: owns this SOP, approves risk-based inspection plans, places stock on hold, authorizes release or disposal, investigates incidents and verifies corrective actions.
Procurement: obtains supplier evidence and prevents purchasing from unapproved sources.
Receiving team: checks documents, product identity, packaging, lot/batch, dates, condition and temperature where applicable.
Warehouse supervisor: enforces FEFO, segregation, cleaning schedules and records.
All staff: follow hygiene rules, report illness/contamination and never bypass a hold or release decision.

3. Core food-safety rules

• Do not receive, store, pick or dispatch food with suspected contamination, compromised packaging, unclear identity or unacceptable temperature history.
• Keep raw animal products physically separated from ready-to-eat foods and protected produce; prevent drips and cross-contact.
• Keep food off floors, away from chemicals, waste, pests, drains and personal belongings.
• Use clean, food-suitable, intact containers and utensils. Never use a chemical container for food.
• Record checks at the time they are performed. Never backdate, fabricate or overwrite records; correct errors with a traceable amendment.

4. Halal assurance certification & vendor verification

4.1 Supplier approval before first purchase

Procurement must create a supplier file and QA must review it before the first halal-sensitive purchase. Verify the supplier's legal/business identity, operating address, product scope, manufacturing or handling site, traceability capability,

complaint/recall contact and any subcontractor or repacking activity. Approval is site- and product-scope-specific; a certificate for one product or facility must not be assumed to cover another.

4.2 Halal evidence checks

For products represented as halal-certified, obtain a current certificate or other acceptable assurance document and verify directly with the issuing halal certification body where a verification channel exists. Check: (a) certificate holder and facility match the supplier and actual source; (b) certificate number and validity dates; (c) product names/categories or annexes include the supplied item; (d) scope covers the relevant processing, storage or handling activity; (e) issuer recognition/accreditation status is acceptable for the destination market and applicable requirements; and (f) no suspension, withdrawal or scope restriction is known. Save a dated copy or verification record.

Do not describe an item as certified merely because the vendor says it is halal, because a different product from the same brand is certified, or because a certificate image is present. If certification is unavailable, expired, unverifiable or outside scope, place the item on HOLD and escalate to QA. Do not market it as certified. QA may approve an alternative assurance route only after documented risk and legal review; otherwise reject or delist it.

4.3 Ingredient and cross-contact review

For processed or multi-ingredient goods, review ingredient/specification sheets and relevant processing aids, flavourings, enzymes, gelatin, emulsifiers and animal-derived inputs where applicable. Ask the supplier to disclose material changes. Review shared-line controls, cleaning/changeover arrangements, storage segregation, transport protection and traceability. Escalate unclear or potentially non-compliant ingredients to QA; do not make assumptions based on ingredient names alone.

4.4 Ongoing verification

Recheck certificates before expiry and at each renewal; set reminders at least 30 days before expiry where practical. Re-verify immediately after a supplier/site/product change, complaint, recall, certification-body alert or suspected integrity breach. Conduct risk-based supplier reviews and retain purchase, batch and delivery links so affected stock can be identified quickly.

5. Organic item intake & chemical residue inspection

5.1 Claims and documentation

Treat “organic”, “certified organic”, “pesticide-free” and similar claims as distinct claims requiring evidence. Before listing or receiving a certified-organic item, obtain current certificate/transaction documentation appropriate to the applicable certification scheme and verify the operator, farm/processor, product, scope, validity and lot linkage. A vendor declaration alone is not proof of certification. Do not relabel conventional goods as organic or mix organic and conventional lots without clear identification and controls.

5.2 Receiving checklist

Check	Pass criteria / action
Identity & claim	Product, variety, grade and organic claim match purchase order, label and supporting documents.
Lot traceability	Farm/producer, supplier, lot/batch and delivery date are recorded and link to supporting documents.
Packaging	Food-grade, clean, intact, dry and correctly labelled; no chemical odour, leakage or evidence of tampering.
Visual condition	No visible mould, decay, unusual residues, pest activity, foreign matter or abnormal damage. Visual checks do not prove residue compliance.
Transport	Vehicle/containers are clean, protected from chemicals and pests, and suitable for the product; temperature checked where relevant.
Segregation	Organic and conventional lots are clearly identified and physically separated or effectively segregated during handling.
Sampling decision	Risk-based sampling/testing is arranged when required by QA, customer specification, alert, history or applicable rules.

5.3 Chemical residue controls

Visual inspection, smell and supplier assurances cannot establish that pesticide or other chemical residues are within legal limits. QA must use a risk-based verification programme: review supplier controls and available test reports; identify higher-risk origins/products or alert-affected lots; select representative samples using a documented sampling plan; use a

competent laboratory with appropriate validated methods; and compare results with the applicable maximum residue limits (MRLs) and market requirements for the specific commodity and jurisdiction. Do not invent a universal MRL or apply one commodity's limit to another.

If a result is missing, inconclusive, outside specification or above an applicable limit, quarantine the affected lot and any linked stock, stop sale/dispatch, notify QA and investigate traceability. Only QA may authorize release after documented satisfactory evidence. Non-compliant stock must be rejected, returned or disposed of through an approved route; notify relevant authorities/customers where legally required and preserve test and disposition records.

6. Expiration auditing — strict FEFO inventory rotation

6.1 FEFO rule

First Expiry, First Out (FEFO) is mandatory. Pick the saleable lot with the earliest valid expiry/use-by date first, regardless of receipt date. FIFO may be used only as a secondary rule when expiry dates are identical or no expiry date applies, and only where QA has defined a suitable control. Never overwrite or obscure a manufacturer's date.

6.2 Receiving and system entry

At intake, record product ID, supplier, lot/batch, quantity, receipt date, manufacture/packing date where provided, expiry/use-by/best-before date exactly as labelled, and storage requirement. Enter each distinct expiry lot as a separate inventory lot in the system. If the date is missing, illegible, contradictory or implausible, place the goods on HOLD and seek supplier clarification; do not estimate a date.

6.3 Storage, picking and daily audit

Place earlier-expiring lots in the designated forward-pick position without compromising temperature, hygiene or segregation. Use clear lot/date labels and system-directed FEFO picking. Warehouse staff must check date order during each pick and complete a documented daily expiry scan of active stock. QA/supervisor must perform a documented weekly sample audit across categories and locations, with increased frequency for short-life/high-risk goods.

6.4 Near-expiry and expired stock

Set product-specific alert windows based on shelf life, sales velocity, supplier terms and customer expectations; there is no single safe universal near-expiry window for all foods. The system should flag approaching dates for QA review, approved markdown or supplier return where lawful and appropriate. Do not sell or dispatch food past a use-by/expiry date or food that QA has blocked. Best-before dates relate primarily to quality in many schemes, but local rules and product-specific instructions govern; staff must not independently override a date restriction. Expired, recalled, damaged or suspect goods must be physically segregated, system-blocked and labelled “NOT FOR SALE”.

6.5 FEFO audit record

Record audit date/time, auditor, SKU, location, lot numbers, labelled dates, quantities, FEFO order observed, near-expiry/expired findings, system-block status, corrective action, responsible person and closure evidence. Investigate repeated exceptions as a process failure, not merely an individual picking error.

7. Warehouse sanitation standards & staff health checks

7.1 Personal hygiene and protective clothing

Staff must report fit for food-handling duty, wear clean work clothing and task-appropriate protective equipment, keep hair restrained/covered where required, maintain short clean nails and wash hands at required points (before handling exposed food, after toilet use, after waste/cleaning, after touching face/phone/raw product, and whenever contaminated). Gloves do not replace handwashing; change gloves between tasks and when torn or contaminated. No eating, smoking, vaping, spitting or chewing gum in food storage/handling zones. Jewellery and personal items must be controlled to prevent contamination.

7.2 Staff illness and fitness-to-work screening

At shift start, supervisors should ask staff to report symptoms or conditions that could contaminate food, including vomiting, diarrhoea, fever with gastrointestinal symptoms, jaundice, infected or uncovered wounds, or a diagnosed communicable illness relevant to food handling. Staff must report symptoms immediately during a shift. Remove symptomatic staff from food handling and follow applicable public-health/medical advice and local rules for exclusion and return to work. Cover minor cuts with a suitable waterproof dressing and glove where appropriate; infected wounds require assessment and no exposed-food

handling until cleared. Keep health information confidential and restrict records to authorized personnel.

Do not ask supervisors to diagnose staff. The purpose of screening is safe work allocation and referral to an appropriate healthcare professional when needed. Do not penalize good-faith reporting of illness.

7.3 Cleaning and sanitation programme

Maintain a written master sanitation schedule covering receiving bays, floors, drains, racks, chillers/freezers, door handles, scales, totes, picking benches, packing stations, waste areas, staff facilities and vehicles/containers under Kifayah control. For each task define area/equipment, frequency, method, approved chemical, dilution/contact time from the product label, required PPE, responsible role and verification method. Clean first to remove soil, then sanitize where required; observe the stated concentration and contact time. Never mix chemicals or decant them into unlabelled containers.

7.4 Minimum routine frequencies (site risk assessment may require more)

Area / item	Minimum routine	Verification
Food-contact benches, scales, reusable totes	Before use, between incompatible tasks, after contamination and at end of shift	Visual check; sanitizer concentration/contact-time record where applicable
Floors and drains	At least daily and immediately after spills	Supervisor inspection; no standing water or residue
Chillers/freezers	Daily spot clean; scheduled full clean based on use and manufacturer guidance	Cleaning log; temperature log reviewed separately
High-touch points and handles	At least each shift and when visibly soiled	Checklist / supervisor sign-off
Waste bins and waste area	Empty before overflow; clean and sanitize on schedule and after leakage	Lids functional; no pest attraction or odour
Pest monitoring points	According to approved pest-control plan; inspect on scheduled visits	Trend findings; close entry points and sanitation gaps
Vehicles / delivery containers	Before loading and after each contaminated or high-risk load	Load-area inspection and cleaning record

7.5 Chemical storage, pest prevention and facility condition

Store cleaning chemicals in a locked or controlled, clearly labelled area physically separate from food, packaging and food-contact equipment. Keep safety data sheets and instructions accessible to authorized staff. Maintain pest-proof doors/screens where feasible, seal gaps, remove standing water, keep stock elevated and allow inspection access. Use a competent pest-control provider where required; protect food and equipment during treatment and retain service reports. Any pest evidence in a food area triggers immediate containment, cleaning, source investigation and QA review.

8. Non-conformance, quarantine and corrective action

Any staff member may stop handling and notify a supervisor when a food-safety concern is observed. Identify and isolate affected product physically; apply a clear HOLD/DO NOT USE label; block the lot in inventory/order systems; preserve packaging, labels and relevant records; and prevent dispatch. QA assesses scope, traceability and customer exposure, then decides release, return, rework (only if safe, lawful and approved) or disposal. Where product may have reached customers, initiate the incident/recall procedure and required notifications. Record root cause, corrective action, owner, due date and effectiveness check.

Immediate escalation triggers

- Suspected halal integrity breach or false certification claim.
- Chemical residue result above an applicable legal/specification limit, or suspected chemical contamination.
- Expired/use-by product picked, sold or dispatched.
- Temperature abuse, pest contamination, foreign matter or suspected foodborne illness complaint.
- Ill staff member handling exposed food where contamination may have occurred.
- Missing traceability or inability to identify affected lots.

9. Records and retention

Maintain controlled records, legible and retrievable, for supplier approval and halal evidence; organic claims and certificates; receiving and lot inspections; laboratory reports and sampling plans; inventory expiry/FEFO audits; cleaning and sanitation; pest control; staff hygiene training and fitness-to-work screening (with confidentiality safeguards); holds, releases, disposal and corrective actions; customer complaints and recall/incident investigations. Retain records for the period required by applicable law, certification scheme, contract and Kifayah's approved retention schedule. Do not set an arbitrary retention period without confirming those requirements.

10. Training, verification and review

Before performing assigned tasks, staff must receive role-specific training on hygiene, cross-contamination prevention, FEFO, date-code interpretation, hold procedures, cleaning chemical safety and escalation. Supervisors document attendance and competency checks. QA verifies implementation through routine inspections, record review, traceability exercises and risk-based internal audits. Revise this SOP after regulatory or certification changes, new product categories, process/site changes, serious incidents or audit findings.

Appendix A — Receiving / intake record fields

Date/time; receiving site; supplier and delivery reference; purchase order; SKU/product description; claim (halal/organic/other); certificate/document reference and validity check; lot/batch; quantity; manufacture/packing and expiry/use-by/best-before dates; packaging/visual condition; transport cleanliness; temperature where applicable; sample ID/lab report reference where applicable; acceptance/HOLD/rejection decision; reason; inspector name/signature; QA release reference.

Appendix B — FEFO audit record fields

Audit date/time; site and storage location; SKU; lot/batch; quantity; labelled date type and date; system sequence; physical pick sequence; near-expiry and expired quantities; blocked status; action taken; assigned owner; closure date; auditor and supervisor sign-off.

Appendix C — Cleaning record fields

Date/time; area/equipment; pre-clean condition; cleaning agent and approved dilution; sanitizer and concentration/contact time where applicable; PPE; staff initials; post-clean inspection result; corrective action/re-clean; supervisor verification.

Appendix D — Reference and implementation note

This SOP is an internal operating template, not a legal opinion, halal certification, laboratory protocol or substitute for a site-specific HACCP/food-safety plan. Before approval, Kifayah must map controls to applicable Pakistani federal and provincial/territorial food laws and competent food authority requirements for each operating location, confirm the accepted halal certification bodies and organic certification schemes for the products/market, validate product-specific temperature and shelf-life controls, and obtain qualified food-safety/legal review. Certification recognition and residue limits can vary by market, commodity and scheme; verify current requirements rather than relying on this template alone.

Approval — Prepared by: Quality Assurance & Hygiene Compliance | Reviewed by: Operations / Procurement | Approved by: Authorized Management Representative | Approval date: _____ | Signature: _____